

Required Formal (Graded) Writing Assignments

1) Research Paper

Topic: The Pros and Cons of Social Networking –

Social networks will allow people to connect, for a variety of reasons, in a digital environment. Professionals might join LinkedIn to meet business contacts; or others, may use Facebook to contact old friends and meet new ones.

Social networking serves to bring people with common interests together, offering exposure to innovative ideas from people around the globe. In addition, for some individuals, it may be seemed as a means to decrease social anxiety. However, at what cost? There are problems associated with social networking such as identity theft, privacy issues, and cyber bullying to name a few.

The paper will require the student to take a position on social networking (pro or con) and defend his or her viewpoint. There are no right or wrong answers – but; be able to defend your position. Cite **six to eight articles - that is (at least three positives and a least three negative views on social networking).**

Paper Requirements:

Length:

Word – Three (3) pages, - not including the Works Cited page.

Format:

Spacing - 1.5 spacing, use default margins,

Font-Size - 12 points,

Font Style - Times New Roman

Sources:

As supporting evidence, cite six to eight articles using the MLA format as covered in your English classes. May cite sources from the CUNY Library database or another academically acceptable source (books, or credible scholarly articles) – no Wikipedia.

Due Date: 10/30

Scaffolded Writing Assignment: Pros and Cons of Social Networking

Scaffolding provides a step-by-step approach to supports students in developing their writing skills.

Write a 5-paragraph essay evaluating the benefits and drawbacks of social networking platforms (e.g., Instagram, TikTok, Facebook, X).

Scaffolding Steps

1. **Brainstorming & Discussion (Date: 9/30)**
 - In small groups, students will list pros and cons of social networking as they can.
 - Leading questions:
 - How does social media help people connect?
 - What are some of the drawbacks of social networking?
 - How does it affect mental health, privacy, or productivity?
2. **Organizing Thoughts (Due Date: 10/7)**
 - Create a table comparing pros and cons.
 - Choose your argument.
3. **Thesis Statement & Topic Sentences (Due Date: 10/9)**
 - Students write a clear thesis statement - introduction.
 - They draft topic sentences for each body paragraph.
4. **Evidence Gathering (Due Date: 10/14)**
 - Students will search out 5 sources (articles, videos, studies) to support their points.
 - They write down quotes or paraphrased evidence with citations.
5. **Outline (Due Date: 10/16)**
 - Students create a structured outline:
 - Introduction with thesis
 - 2 body paragraphs (one pro or one con)
 - Give and defend your viewpoint
 - Conclusion
6. **Drafting (Due Date: 10/21)**
 - Students write their first draft using the outline.
 - Focus on clarity and supporting evidence.
 - Professor will view the draft.
7. **Peer Review (Due Date: 10/23)**
 - Students exchange papers and give feedback using a rubric.
 - Emphasis on argument strength, organization, and grammar.
- A small blue icon representing a Microsoft Word document, with a white 'W' on a blue background.

Peer Review Rubric
10_19.docx

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8. **Revision (Due Date: 10/28)**
 - Students revise based on feedback from instructor and classmates.
 - Final essay submitted with a reflection paragraph on what they learned.
9. **Final Submission (Due Date: 10/30)**

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Or:

Professor, along with the class, will choose which writing assignment:
Social Media or Artificial Intelligence.

Topic: Exploring Artificial Intelligence

Artificial Intelligence is rapidly transforming industries, education, and everyday life. Your paper will examine the impact of artificial intelligence (AI) on society. What are the implications for society? Choose an industry and discuss the impact of AI in that field.

The paper should explore the following areas.

Define AI.

Describe real-world applications of AI in one field (e.g., healthcare, education, business, entertainment).

Discuss the benefits and risks in AI.

What role will humans play in AI? What are the ethical considerations?

Paper Requirements:

Length:

Word – Three (3) pages, - not including the Works Cited page.

Format:

Spacing - 1.5 spacing, use default margins,

Font-Size - 12 points,

Font Style - Times New Roman

Sources:

As supporting evidence, cite five to eight articles using the MLA format as covered in your English classes. May cite sources from the CUNY Library database or another academically acceptable source (books, or credible scholarly articles) – no Wikipedia.

Due Date: 10/30

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Scaffolding Steps - AI

1. **Brainstorming & Discussion (Due Date: 9/30)**
 - In small groups, students will discuss the impact of artificial intelligence (AI) on society. discuss some of the issues associated with AI.
 - Leading questions:
 - Will AI replace jobs or create new ones?
 - What are some of the drawbacks of AI?
 - What are the ethical concerns of AI? Should there be regulations? By Whom?
 - As a student going into the workforce, how do you prepare yourself for the present future?
2. **Organizing Thoughts (Due Date: 10/7)**
 - Create a table - old job replacement/news jobs creation.
3. **Thesis Statement & Topic Sentences (Due Date: 10/9)**
 - Students write a clear thesis statement – opening statement.
 - They draft topic sentences for each body paragraph.
4. **Evidence Gathering (Due Date: 10/14)**
 - Students will search out 5 sources (articles, videos, studies) to support their points.
 - They write down quotes or paraphrased evidence with citations.
5. **Outline (Due Date: 10/16)**
 - Students create a structured outline:
 - Introduction with thesis
 - 3 body paragraphs
 - Conclusion
6. **Drafting (Due Date: 10/21)**
 - Students write their first draft using the outline.
 - Focus on clarity and supporting evidence.
7. **Peer Review (Due Date: 10/23)**
 - Students exchange papers and give feedback using a rubric.
 - Emphasis on argument strength, organization, and grammar.
8. **Revision (Due Date: 10/28)**
 - Revisions based on feedback from instructor and peers.
 - Final essay submitted with a reflection paragraph on what they learned.
9. **Final Submission (Due Date: 10/30)**

Peer Review Rubric

Peer Review

Title of Paper:

Author(s):

Reviewer:

Date:

1. Thesis of the Paper

Is there a clear opening statement? Is the position taken clearly identified? Are opposing viewpoints acknowledged?

2. Critical Thinking

Are the ideas well thought out? Have the ideas been fully developed? Or, does it simply describe or summarize information? ☐ Ideas are well thought out ☐ Moderate - reasonably developed ☐ Weak – need improvement

Comments:

3. Writing Quality

Is the paper well-written and easy to follow? Are the sentences clearly written? Are grammar and spelling correct? ☐ Excellent ☐ Good ☐ Fair ☐ Needs Improvement

Comments:

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4. Strengths

What are the strong points of the paper? **Consider clarity, well thought out ideas, and supporting evidence.** Is it logically organized (introduction, body, conclusion)? Does it include reflection – what was learned.

5. Areas for Improvement

What could be improved? **Consider organization (logically organized sequence statements), sources, clarity, or grammar.**

6. Overall Evaluation

Is this paper ready for submission? ☐ Yes ☐ With Revisions ☐ No

Final Comments:

Areas needing revision:

Suggestions:

[Type here]

2) Reflection Paper

Topic: Exploring How Emerging Technology Will Influence My Computer Career Path

Assignment Overview

Throughout history, new tools have reshaped the way people live, work, and learn. Today, emerging technologies such as Artificial Intelligence (AI), Machine Learning, Cybersecurity and the impact of social media are shaping the opportunities and challenges of tomorrow.

Technology and emerging tools—such as artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, and social media—may give thought as to reshaping or altering our academic goal and career path.

In this assignment, you will write a reflection paper that demonstrates your understanding of technology as it relates to your future studies and career path. In other words, how the emerging technologies may influence your learning, and the career path you are contemplating.

Describe specific lessons, concepts, from the course, which shaped your views – influenced your personal goals and viewpoints.

Paper Requirements:

Length:

Word- Two (2) pages – not including the Works Cited page.

Format:

Spacing - 1.5 spacing, use default margins,

Font-Size - 12 points,

Font Style - Times New Roman

Sources:

Cite your sources using the MLA format. A minimum of four (4) sources required – including the textbook. May cite sources from the CUNY Library database or another academically acceptable source (books, or credible scholarly articles) – no Wikipedia.

Due Date: 11/22

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3) Team Project

Final Project –

The final project will be a team project which will include an oral presentation. The team will collaborate with each other and choose a subject matter, i.e. such as networking, from the textbook to further research. The final project will require the students to use the Microsoft Office applications – Word, Access, and PowerPoint. Each team will present their final project using PowerPoint – the presentation software. The MLA format will be used to cite references.

Each portion will be worth 25 points.

Requirements:

Word – Three (3) pages, Spacing - 1.5 spacing, use default margins, Font-Size - 12 points, Font Style - Times New Roman (25 points)

Access – 5 records (25 points)

PowerPoint Slides – 9 slides. Introduction will count as slide one. Last page citing references will count at the ninth page. (25 points)

Oral Presentation (25 points)

Due Date: 12/21

Rubric - Grading of Formal Projects

The rubric will help students understand what is expected and give clear feedback.

Name:

Assignment:

Date:

Criteria	20	15	10	Comments	Grading
Organization & Structure	Clear, logical structure; smooth transitions; strong introduction and conclusion. Clarity of Argument: Is the main purpose clearly defined and easy to identify?	Adequate structure; some transitions; thesis present but may lack clarity. Argument is clear and mostly well-supported, with minor gaps in logic or evidence.	Disorganized; weak or missing introduction; poor transitions Argument is vague or underdeveloped; lacks sufficient support or coherence.		
Critical Thinking-beyond simply describing or summarizing information. Instead, focus on analyzing, evaluating, and synthesizing ideas.	Insightful analysis; original insights; strong support with evidence	Sufficient analysis; some original thought; evidence used appropriately	Superficial or off-topic; lacks depth; weak or missing evidence		
Research & Sources	Skillful integration of credible sources; proper citation format	Uses sources with some integration; citation format mostly correct	Few or poor sources; improper or missing citations		
Revision & Feedback Use	Demonstrates substantial revision based on feedback; clear improvement	Some revision evident; feedback partially addressed	Minimal or no revision; feedback ignored		
Grammar & Mechanics Style & Tone	Error-free; complex sentence structure Professional tone; varied and precise word choice.	Some errors; generally clear and readable Appropriate tone; some variety in language.	Frequent errors; hinders readability Inconsistent or inappropriate tone; repetitive or vague language		
Grade	Overall Comments:				

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